Installation and Configuration

Day 1 - From Theory to Practice

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What We'll Do

By the end of this session, you will be able to:

1. **Launch and configure Cursor** on your machine
2. **Use the agent panel** to generate code from a prompt
3. **Start building a webapp** with AI assistance

Phase 1

Environment Setup

Step 1: Verify Cursor Is Installed

Open a terminal and run:

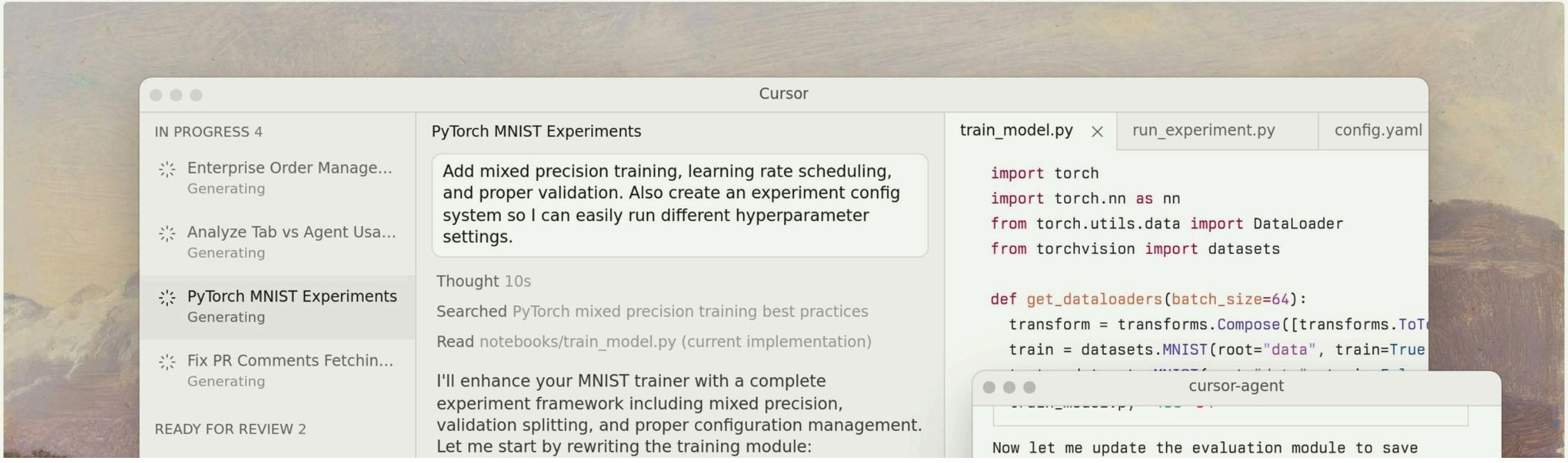
```
cursor --version
```

See a version number? Skip to Step 2.

Nothing happens? Download from `https://cursor.com` → Linux.

Built to make you extraordinarily productive, Cursor is the best way to code with AI.

Download for Linux



Step 2: Log In

You've received a **Cursor Pro account**.

1. Open Cursor
2. Click **Sign In** (or Settings → Account)
3. Enter the email and password from your credential sheet
4. Verify you see **Pro** in your account status

Step 3: Basic Configuration

Cursor works great with defaults. Just verify:

- **Theme** - dark or light, your preference
- **Model** - leave on default
- **Extensions** - none needed today

That's it. We go deep on configuration **tomorrow**.

Phase 2

Your First Agent Interaction

The Core Loop

This is the **one thing** you need to know:

1. **Open the agent panel** - `Ctrl+I`
2. **Type a prompt** - describe what you want in plain English
3. **Watch it generate** - the agent writes code, creates files
4. **Accept the result** - review and click Accept

The Core Loop

Prompt → Generate → Accept

That's it. This loop powers the rest of your afternoon.

Live Demo

Watch what happens:

- Agent **reads the context** (empty folder)
- **Creates files** automatically
- **Writes working code** you can run

That's All You Need For Now

Cursor has **many more features**: ways to give the agent better context, plan multi-step tasks, integrate with external tools, and more.

We cover all of that **tomorrow** in the Advanced Cursor session.

For today: **agent panel + plain English prompt = enough to build.**

Phase 3

FreeSelfApp - Build Your First Webapp

The Challenge

You have **~1h45** (this session + Parts 1 and 2) to build a **frontend webapp**.

The rules:

- **It must be a webapp** - runs in a browser
- **Any tech stack** - React, Vue, Svelte, vanilla JS, your call
- **No rules on structure or process** - just build

Three Ideas to Get You Started

1. Recipe Finder

Enter ingredients → get matching recipes

2. Habit Tracker

Daily habit checklist with streaks

3. Movie Watchlist

Browse, save, and rate movies

Have your own idea? Go for it. Only requirement: it's a webapp.

Suggested First Prompts

Recipe Finder:

> *"Create a Recipe Finder webapp where users type ingredients and see matching recipes with name, description, and cooking time."*

Habit Tracker:

> *"Build a Habit Tracker with a list of habits, daily check-off, and streak counter."*

Movie Watchlist:

> *"Create a Movie Watchlist where users browse movies, add to watchlist, and rate from 1-5 stars."*

If You Get Stuck

- **Rephrase your prompt** - be more specific, or break it into smaller requests
- **Ask the agent to fix it** - describe what's wrong
- **Raise your hand** - for technical blockers only
- **Don't worry about** code quality, structure, or "doing it right"

There is no "right" today. Just build.

Go Build

1. **Create a new folder** for your project
2. **Open it in Cursor** - File → Open Folder
3. **Open the agent** - `Ctrl+I`
4. **Paste your first prompt** and let it generate
5. **Keep going** - ask for features, fix bugs, iterate

Key Takeaways

1. **Cursor's core loop is simple** - agent panel, prompt, accept
2. **The AI writes code from your descriptions** - you guide and review
3. **Start messy, iterate fast** - today is about experience, not polish
4. **Tomorrow we go deeper** - context management, system prompts, MCP, structured workflows

What's Next

When	What
Now (2:30 PM)	Continue building - FreeSelfApp Part 1
After break (3:45 PM)	More building - FreeSelfApp Part 2
End of day (4:30 PM)	Debrief - reflect on what you built
Tomorrow (9:15 AM)	Advanced Cursor - agent strategy, MCP, system prompts

Questions?

Keep building. We'll debrief at 4:30 PM.